
Philipp Hilbert. *Technical Product Owner, Cargo & Aviation Operations.*

Positioning, Product manager with 13 years of backlog ownership in regulated, operations-heavy domains, ready to run the TPO function for dnata Cargo from day one.

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§ WHY EMIRATES

Emirates Group IT operates at a scale most product organisations never reach: roughly 50 teams running in a Scaled Agile Framework, PI planning cycles across genuinely complex logistics and airline operations domains, and a cargo business, dnata, that moves freight through one of the world's busiest hubs. That combination of operational depth and engineering scale is exactly the environment where structured backlog ownership, cross-functional alignment, and a bias for measurable outcomes compound quickly. The TPO role sits at the precise intersection of those things: owning story content, acceptance criteria, and NFR prioritisation across multiple team backlogs while partnering with business counterparts on value delivery. That interface between engineering rigour and operational reality is where I have spent the better part of a decade. *That is exactly the kind of work where the habits I have built pay off fastest.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

I have not shipped a product inside an air cargo or ground handling operation specifically, though logistics systems featured in my engineering degree and I have owned delivery in analogous domains, regulated, high-throughput, operations-critical. The transferable core is strong: I am practised at mapping complex operational workflows into refined, acceptance-criteria-backed backlogs, and at partnering with domain experts to fill the gap between my own knowledge and theirs.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo spec and edge-case generation
 - **GitHub Copilot**, development pairing and refactor support
 - **Cursor / VSCode**, AI-assisted code review and context navigation
 - **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping for discovery
 - **Gamma.app**, stakeholder decks and PI demo prep
 - **GPT**, research synthesis and user-story drafting
 - **n8n**, agentic workflow design and LLM orchestration
 - **Framer**, lightweight clickable prototypes
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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps rollout and rollback, Jenkins, CI/CD pipelines, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin / Spring Boot, Jira, Confluence, Miro, Figma.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Two-sided B2B marketplace matching construction firms with workers, built and operated solo.

- Anonymity-until-payment model that protects both sides of the hire until commitment is made.
- WhatsApp and Telegram as the primary product surface, chosen for zero-install adoption in a trade-worker target segment.
- LLM agents across the full funnel, inbound qualification, matching logic, follow-up, so one person runs the day-to-day operations.
- Demonstrates end-to-end TPO capability: discovery, story writing, implementation, and funnel analysis in SQL without a supporting team.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT EMIRATES

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow PI planning artefacts, existing backlog structure, and team ceremonies to understand how work flows from the dnata Cargo business counterparts through to the engineering teams, and where the refinement bottlenecks actually live.

WEEK 2

Audit, slice, clarify.

Walk every open epic with the team, apply consistent acceptance criteria and DoD, identify undocumented NFRs and technical debt items, and surface the dependencies that need flagging to the Product Portfolio backlog.

WEEK 3+

Run the cadence.

Own the refinement rhythm, lead story sign-off, feed metrics back to the TPM community, and bring the first team-driven innovation ideas to the PI demo pipeline.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Emirates Group IT Recruitment Team,

I am writing to apply for the Technical Product Owner role within dnata Cargo. With thirteen years of backlog ownership in regulated, operations-critical domains, including a SAFe environment spanning agile release trains and PI planning, I am confident I can step into the TPO function and add immediate value to your teams in Dubai.

The role description maps closely to how I have worked across my career. At Rohde & Schwarz I owned the full backlog for an AI and data platform serving the FCAS European programme: story content, acceptance criteria, NFR prioritisation, technical debt tracking, and release gating, all coordinated across a cross-functional team of fifteen-plus engineers and data scientists running Scrum in Jira and Confluence. I introduced GitOps delivery with ArgoCD and reduced rollout time from days to thirty minutes, which also made the platform hotfix-capable, exactly the kind of non-functional improvement that is easy to defer and expensive to ignore. At Scheidt & Bachmann I worked within a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI

planning, moving research results into production across a matrix organisation, the closest structural parallel to the Emirates Group IT model described in the posting.

The B2B and operations-heavy context of dnata Cargo is where my background in regulated, high-throughput domains is most relevant. At EMIL Group I restructured an eighteen-person delivery organisation into three lean teams, halted attrition, and shipped the Claims Center from concept to production with no existing precedent. At the Bundesagentur für Arbeit I carried a full UI relaunch, a large ETL migration, and a containerisation programme concurrently, introducing Dagster and dbt to eliminate manual data-update overhead. Both experiences taught me that the TPO role is not just backlog hygiene: it is about protecting team capacity from noise, surfacing the right risks and dependencies early, and keeping the delivery organisation oriented around outcomes that the business can actually measure. Defining those metrics, and checking whether they moved after delivery, has been a consistent practice across every role I have held.

On the AI dimension: I work with LLM agents and agentic workflows daily, not as a curiosity but as a productivity layer that makes discovery, spec writing, and edge-case generation faster and more thorough. I have prototyped and shipped with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable, and n8n, and I design human-in-the-loop evaluation loops as a standard part of AI feature work. I would bring that same hands-on orientation to identifying and consolidating team-driven innovation ideas for playback to the TPM community, one of the responsibilities the posting highlights explicitly.

I am actively targeting the UAE and am fully prepared to relocate to Dubai and work on-site. I hold EU citizenship, require no visa sponsorship in Europe, and am available within four weeks of an offer. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my background fits the dnata Cargo TPO role and the broader Emirates Group IT product organisation.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product manager and Product Owner with 13 years of backlog ownership in regulated, operations-critical environments. I have run Scrum and SAFe delivery across defence AI, public-sector analytics, insurance, healthcare, payments, and retail, always in a team-facing capacity, owning story content, acceptance criteria, NFR tracking, and sprint discipline from PI planning through to production. I partner with business counterparts to translate strategy into a prioritised, executable backlog, and I measure delivery against outcomes, not output.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAgile (Scaled Agile Framework), ART (agile release train), PI planning, WIP limits, velocity and burndown, release gating.

Product Ownership: backlog refinement, user stories, acceptance criteria, definition of done, epics, story-point estimation, sprint planning, UAT (user acceptance testing), Jira, Confluence.

Product Management: continuous discovery, product roadmap, MVP definition, PoC, A/B testing, user research, prototyping, go-to-market support, B2B SaaS delivery.

Stakeholder and Leadership: cross-functional team leadership, C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, dependency and risk management.

SDLC and Delivery Practices: GitOps, CI/CD, test automation, regression gating, containerised environments, same-day hotfix paths, cycle time as a product metric.

Analytics and Data: KPI definition, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, funnel analysis, Matomo.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, human-in-the-loop design, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI); prototyping with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

Technical Environments Owned: Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, Jenkins, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka.

Governance: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI & DATA PLATFORM
2024-2025

Led cross-functional team of 15+ through Scrum; owned full backlog, acceptance criteria, and NFR prioritisation for the FCAS AI platform. GitOps delivery with ArgoCD cut rollout from days to 30 minutes; developer-first pivot increased pipeline runs 200%.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC-SECTOR ANALYTICS
2023-2024

Deputy IT Security Officer. Introduced Dagster and dbt, cutting data-update time by 75%; migrated bare-metal to containers; carried UI relaunch and ETL migration concurrently. Jenkins CI/CD pipeline test automation freed several QA hours per week.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE APP 2023

Cut bloated roadmap to top 10% of features against agreed success measures; user acceptance rose fivefold. Implemented CGM interface into hospital KIS workflows, reducing digital anamnesis from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS 2022

Restructured 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams; attrition fell from near-total exodus to one departure. Shipped Claims Center concept to production; cut time-to-market for new insurance products from months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER · RETAIL PAYMENTS (SAFE) 2021-2022

PI planning, ART ceremonies, and backlog ownership in a fully SAFe environment with agile release trains across a retail POS and forecourt matrix organisation.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · GOVERNMENT DATA PLATFORM 2021

Data structures and identity management for Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTH INSURANCE E-COMMERCE 2019-2020

Migrated legacy procurement system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and ~20,000 employees. Backlog refinement, user stories, and acceptance criteria in Jira; system still in production.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · ENERGY SITE IT 2019

End-to-end IT modernisation for wind-energy sites in Wismar and Magdeburg.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · CLINICAL NETWORK 2017-2018

Wi-Fi infrastructure rollout and network product ownership across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER & PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION B2B MARKETPLACE 2025-2026

Zero-to-one two-sided B2B marketplace; LLM agents across the funnel; SQL-based conversion analysis; sole operator.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER & PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE ENCRYPTION
2016-2021

Owned hardware-software product architecture; shipped three-layer solution installing in under two minutes for enterprise buyers. Later Chair of the board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO & CFO · AGRI-
NANOTECHNOLOGY 2018-2021

Lab to investor rounds; owned financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER & CFO · FINTECH P2P PAYMENTS
2013-2018

Built mobile group P2P payment product from zero to acquisition by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · EMIRATES

